

What's in Your Toolbox?
The Politics of Travel in the Context of Globalization

Class Meeting time(s): TuTh 10:10-Noon – Reed Hall 107

X-Hour: Fri 3:30-4:20 p.m. (as needed)

PRO TIP: Always keep your X-Hours free. Try not to schedule work or other activities. Your Toolbox X-Hour is a time we know we can come together for group activities.

INSTRUCTOR:

Casey Aldrich: casey.j.aldrich@dartmouth.edu

Mokhtar Bouba: mokhtar.bouba@dartmouth.edu

OFFICE HOURS:

Casey's Office Hours:

- Drop-in Wednesdays, 1:00 - 2:30 & by appointment
- Haldeman 141 @ The Dickey Center for International Understanding
- To schedule an appointment, visit my Calendly <https://calendly.com/casey-aldrich> [Links to an external site.](#)

Mokhtar's Office Hours:

- Drop-in Wednesdays, 1:00 - 2:30 & by appointment
- 101C Bartlett Hall
- To schedule an appointment email mokhtar.bouba@dartmouth.edu

“Office Hours” give you an opportunity to meet one-on-one with me, your instructor. They are one of the best ways for us to get to know each other and for you to boost your learning. Office hours serve many purposes—you can ask questions, get clarification, continue a conversation, review writing drafts, build a relationship, share difficulties, seek insight and advice, discuss your interests, brainstorm ideas, request a letter of recommendation, demonstrate make-up of missed work, etc. Office hours are an invaluable resource. Plus, we really enjoy getting to know you as individuals outside the classroom.

COURSE DESCRIPTION

Traveling can be transformative. But transformative travel does not happen simply by virtue of hopping on a plane and appearing in another culture someplace on the globe. Gaining a true sense of place happens through reflection and a critical awareness of self and others in the context of place, culture, and systems of power. The Toolbox will prepare you for mindful, ethical travel by equipping you with the research and reflection tools you'll need to maximize your global travel and living and learning

experiences. Through multidisciplinary readings and a series of out-of-class activities here in the Upper Valley with members of our own local communities, The Toolbox will give you time to reflect on who and where you are today. It will also equip you with culture-specific knowledge, culture-general concepts, and a toolbox of transferable intercultural skills and competencies. (SOC, CI).

LEARNING OUTCOMES:

By the end of this course, you will be able to:

- recognize yourself and others as complex, intersectional, cultural beings
- appreciate that intercultural competence—the ability to communicate and act appropriately and effectively across cultural difference—is a lifelong skill and a sensibility acquired over time and through ongoing trial and error.
- understand how systems and networks connect people and places and create unequal power dynamics that are often taken for granted or unquestioned.
- analyze, through an interdisciplinary framework, the relationship between people, culture, and place, in the context of globalization.
- practice critical reflection independently using a range of reflective writing frameworks
- use “tools” you have acquired in the course to gain a better sense of place and engagement for the places you visit and live

REQUIRED TEXT:

- There are no required texts for this course. All reading material will be available via Canvas (our course learning management system).

IMPORTANT NOTE: To pass this class, you will need to attend all the scheduled events and submit all your reflection essays plus a completed final guided reflection. More than one unexcused absence will have an impact on your final grade. If you are sick or need to miss class for another reason, let us know. Do not ask “did I miss anything?” The answer is always “Yes, you did!” Ask your classmates. Do the work of catching up—look at Canvas or schedule a time to see one of us during office hours.

ASSIGNMENTS & ASSESSMENT:

Active Participation & Attendance

Online in Canvas and in class in person 25%

short weekly online assignments, including QQTPs
in-class group work, active listening, & discussion
attendance (more than 1 unexcused absence will impact your grade)

Audio Projects Culture & Sound: 4 short audio projects 20%

A soundscape (Dartmouth) & Reflection	(5%)
A soundscape (Home) & Reflection	(5%)

Migration Stories Unscripted	(5%)
Audio Postcard and Artist Statement	(5%)
Poster Project: Why We Travel/How We Travel	15%
Poster Creation & Peer Review	(10%)
Artist Statement	(5%)
Reflection Essays x 5 (2-3-pages on out-of-class activities)	25%
Final Guided Reflection: Short written answers	15%

EXTENSIONS

The deadlines for reading and writing in *The Toolbox* have been set to maximize class discussion and feedback. If you need a one- or two-day extension for a writing assignment, especially your reflection essays, simply ask and propose a new deadline. Within reason, we can be flexible.

DESCRIPTION OF MAJOR ASSIGNMENTS:

Audio Projects – During the first six weeks of class, you will create 4 short audio projects. No prior experience is required. We will have a series of workshops at the Jones Media Center (JMC) and Susan Simon and Sarah Storms '23 (JMC Media Fellow) will be on hand to guide you with this work. Tourism and travel tend to prioritize sight (photography, sightseeing). We would like to foreground sound. We will use these assignments to think about the sound of culture and how deep listening can help us develop a sense of place for the sites we visit.

Poster Project – The subtitle for our class is “the politics of travel.” The word politics encourages us to think about questions of power, privilege, and positionality. Who travels? Under what circumstances? How do you travel? Why? Who do we meet when we arrive? Who is invisible and why? Working with Sarah Smith and Betty Kim '20 from the Book Arts Workshop, each of you will design an “activist poster” designed to raise awareness to some of these issues.

Reflection Essays – Experiential learning, or learning by doing, forms the heart of this course. We have several class excursions designed to help us develop a sense of place and perspective for where we are now—Dartmouth, Hanover, the Upper Valley, USA. Learning from experience comes about through reflection so we will be asking you to write a series of reflective, first-person essays about your experiences, what you are learning from them, and how that learning is complementing the theory and discussions we have in class.

Weekly QQTPs – Finally, your QQTPs are 1-page reading notes based on assigned texts. A “text” could refer written, video, or audio material. We assign these to promote active reading and to give you a

document you can use to participate in class discussion. The first Q stands for “Quotations”—what are some key or intriguing quotes from the week’s readings? The second Q stands for “Questions”—what are a few questions you have about these texts? The TP stands for “Talking Points”—using the readings as your inspiration, what you would like to talk about in class? **The QQTPs are also an accountability tool. We get to see how you are doing with the course materials.**

TEACHING METHODS AND PHILOSOPHY

Our class will be conducted as a workshop/seminar. This means that we will lecture little and ask that you each take an active role in creating a productive class dynamic. This will require that you get to know each other early in the term and come to class prepared to talk with (not at) and listen actively to each other. Together—as a community of learners—we will analyze and interpret texts, tell personal stories, think together out loud, share ideas, and pose questions. Sometimes we will start the discussion. Other times, we will ask you to take the lead. We expect you to participate actively in every class session and on Canvas. You will write regularly. There will be a lot of pair and group work complemented with all-class discussions. This will be “our” class and together we will make it a unique learning experience specific to the needs, wants, and interests of the group.

HOW WE GRADE:

We want you all to be successful in this class and, to the best of our abilities, we will work with you to ensure that happens. We want you to experience growth as a thinker, as a writer, as a student, and as a critic. We hope that you walk away from the class feeling a sense of self-efficacy and confidence. We want you to be able to take what you learn here with you not only into other classes but into life itself. We know “success” in school often translates into an “A” grade but what does that really mean? Trying to “get an A” in class can raise anxiety levels or result in a pattern of playing it safe. Think about all the times in your life when you’ve really learned and really grown. We suspect that process involved a fair amount of practice, a fair amount of trial and error. We will create a space in this class for you to practice reflective writing and for testing out your ideas.

For much of the course, our grading will be **FORMATIVE**. Formative assessment is a type of assessment designed to help you learn and practice. We will give you prompt and constructive feedback on your work so that you can learn from your mistakes and hone your skills. The focus will be on progress and growth. Formative assessment happens regularly and often. As we approach the end of the course, our grading will move to **SUMMATIVE** assessment. Summative assessment assesses your final performance—that final presentation, that final comprehensive reflection, that final audio project. Here we will be looking to see if you demonstrate proficiency in the skills we have studied in class and knowledge of the ideas shared. Most of the grading you will have experienced in school, we suspect, has been summative assessment. *If you are concerned about not knowing your grade or are simply curious about my grading practices, please speak to one of us; we are happy to give you additional feedback.*

EXPECTATIONS

- **Participation and Community:** we hope our class will become an active community of learning. This will be easier to do if we all invest time in learning everyone's name and making a point of getting to

know each other. We each bring unique skills and knowledge to the class and every member can serve as a resource to the group. In college, we all learn from each other—students from teachers, teachers from students, and students from students. That is what a learning community is.

- **Use of Canvas:** Our Canvas site (CANVAS) will be our virtual classroom and it will take shape as the class progresses. You will use Canvas to access all the class texts, including films, and to engage in asynchronous discussions with each other. Please, also use CANVAS to check in with each other, to have discussions, to stay abreast of changes to the syllabus, and to post supplemental materials related to the course themes.
- **Communication:** Keep in touch with us regularly via office hours or email. If we don't reply within 24 hours, email again. We love talking to students and no question is too small or irrelevant. We are also open to your ideas and suggestions. Don't forget to talk to each other too! *If you are concerned or simply curious about your progress in the course, please speak to us; we are happy to give additional feedback.*
- **Attendance:** We expect you to come to every class and be prepared to participate fully in our discussions and activities. More than 1 unexcused absence will have a negative impact on your grade.
- **Absences:** If you need to be absent due to sickness or another extenuating circumstance, email us to let us know. Try to email BEFORE class. If you email AFTER class, do not ask "did I miss anything?" The answer is always "Yes, you did!" Figure out what you think you missed by asking your classmates and looking at Canvas. When you can, make up the work you missed, and find a way to demonstrate that you are up to date. Office hours can be a good place to do this.
- **Class Preparation:** You will have something to do ahead of every class, usually a combination of reading, viewing, and writing. Reading actively (i.e., taking notes, annotating a text) always takes longer than we think. Plan ahead so that you have time to do all the work. Don't leave it until the last minute.
- **Participation:** We run our class as a discussion/workshop. That means that we don't lecture very often and that we expect you to participate actively in class. What does that mean? It means coming to class prepared with notes, questions, observations. It means listening actively to your classmates when they speak and asking clarifying questions or building on their thoughts.
- **Punctuality:** Do your best to always be on time for class. We will start our classes promptly.
- **Food & Drink:** Eating and drinking in class is fine if you do it discreetly (i.e., avoid noisy foods), clean up any mess, and don't disrupt any activities.
- **Technology Use:** Canvas is our virtual classroom. We will keep Canvas updated and use it to communicate with you via announcements. Check it regularly. You may bring your computer and

phone to class but put them away when we are having a discussion. At no point during class should you be texting, checking social media, or doing work for other classes. Turn your ringers off!

YOU CAN EXPECT US TO

- Get to know each of you as an individual and support you with your learning.
- Come prepared for class, facilitate discussion, and bring engaging student-centered activities.
- Provide prompt, constructive, and formative feedback on your writing (formative feedback is the type that helps you learn and grow without fear of the grade).
- Bring good positive energy to the class.
- Understand when you are having a bad day.

CLASS CLIMATE AND INCLUSIVITY

Our Classroom as a Brave Space

It is my hope that our classroom and the community we build here will be a “brave space” (Arao & Clemens, 2013). Brave spaces are spaces that we build together. Brave spaces are inclusive. They are welcoming. They are spaces of active listening, of dialogue, and of voluntary sharing. They are spaces where everyone feels respected and valued and where no one feels silenced. They are spaces where everyone feels challenged and supported. A brave space is where we tackle difficult topics with the shared goal of deeper collective understanding. A brave space is not always a comfortable space and that’s OK. Let’s use our discomfort to question ourselves and, respectfully, challenge each other. Let’s accept that our worldview is partial, our positions in the world different, and we all (even the authors we read) have blind spots and biases. Let’s ask ourselves: “How do I know that?” “Who taught me that?” “Why does this make me uncomfortable or sad or angry?” Emotions can be powerful teachers too; tap into those emotions, read closely, listen actively, and let’s see what happens...

Communication Guidelines for Brave Spaces

1. **Welcome multiple viewpoints:** Speak from your own experience by using “I-statements.” Ask questions to understand the sources of disagreements.
2. **Own your intentions and your impacts:** Respect each other’s experiences and feelings by taking responsibility for the effects of your words. On the other hand, if you have a strong reaction to something, let the group know. Be open to dialogue.
3. **Work to recognize your privileges:** Use this space to recognize and investigate your privileges (for example, class, gender, sexual orientation, ability). Honor the different experiences we all bring to this space.
4. **Take risks:** Lean into discomfort We are all in process. Challenge yourself to contribute even if it is not perfectly formulated.
5. **Step back:** Share speaking time and try to speak after others who have not spoken.
6. **Notice and name group dynamics in the moment:** We are all responsible for this space. Be aware of how others are responding or not responding. Ask for a “time out” or dialogue if needed.
7. **Actively listen:** Use your energy to listen to what is said before thinking about how to respond. Notice when defensiveness and denial arise.
8. **Challeng[e] with care:** Find ways to respectfully challenge others and be open to challenges of your own views. Think about how to question ideas without personal attacks.
9. **[Respect] confidentiality:** Share the message, not the messenger.
10. **Break it down:** Use simple language and background information when necessary. Ask for clarification if needed.

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POLICIES AND RESOURCES

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

The Toolbox has been designed with the idea of collaboration at its heart. You are, thus, encouraged to work together to discuss readings and films or brainstorm and share your writing and ideas. That said, the work you produce for this class should be original. Do not submit work that you have already published or produced for another source. Do not use ChatGPT or any other Generative AI to produce ideas for, to draft or improve your essays, unless instructed by us, your professors (see below).

Using Generative AI outside of class for your *Toolbox* writing assignments would be a violation of the Academic Honor Principle. Why? You have chosen to come to college to learn, and not simply facts but also transferable skills and abilities that will serve you throughout your adult life and in many different contexts. Understanding texts, generating ideas and writing are hard and often time-consuming. Yet writing—wrestling with thoughts and ideas—is one of the best ways to think. By writing about something, over time you grow to understand it. Deeply. Writing also helps you externalize your thoughts and feelings about something and make sense of experiences. Through writing you develop your own unique voice and views on the world. You also come to know yourself. Finally, writing allows you to communicate with others, to raise awareness about topics you care about. Writing, therefore, despite the challenges, can be an incredibly rewarding and empowering process too.

You cannot use a Gen AI tool to:

- Write your reflection essays or any other reflection assignment
- Complete your QQTP reading assignments
- Write the script for your Audio Postcard
- Write definitions of concepts

You may use a Gen AI to:

- Generate and improve the titles of your essays
- Organize your class notes for review to prepare your QQTP
- Brainstorm ideas for your poster

For more information about the Academic Honor Principle (AHP) at Dartmouth go to <https://students.dartmouth.edu/judicial-affairs/policy/academic-honor-principle>

For more information about how to cite your sources please review:

<http://writing-speech.dartmouth.edu/learning/materials/sources-and-citations-dartmouth>

Another great resource for how to correctly cite sources using different citation formats is the Online Writing Lab at Purdue University: OWL.Purdue.edu

COMMITMENTS TOWARD YOUR SUCCESS IN THIS COURSE

As course designers and instructors, we are committed to the successful achievement of your goals in this course. We also understand that you may face challenges during the term. Resources are available to help you. These may include:

ACADEMIC ACCOMMODATIONS

If you are requesting disability-related accommodations and services for this course, you must register with Student Accessibility Services ([Getting Started with SAS webpage](#); student.accessibility.services@dartmouth.edu; 1-603-646-9900) and to request that an accommodation email be sent to me in advance of the need for an accommodation. Then, you should schedule a follow-up meeting with me to figure out relevant details such as what role SAS or its [Testing Center](#) may play in accommodation implementation. This process works best for when completed as early in the quarter as possible. If you have questions about whether you are eligible for accommodations, or if you have concerns about the implementation of your accommodations, you should contact the SAS office. All inquiries and discussions will remain confidential.

MENTAL HEALTH AND WELLBEING SUPPORT

The academic environment is challenging, our terms are intensive, and classes are not the only demanding part of your life. There are several resources available to you on campus to support your wellness, including:

1. Your Undergraduate Dean at the [Undergraduate Deans Office](#) (they have drop-in advising too)
2. OPAL (the Office of Pluralism and Leadership, Dr. Rae's office)
<https://students.dartmouth.edu/opal/advising/about-advising>)
3. The Counseling Center (<https://students.dartmouth.edu/health-service/counseling/about>)
4. Student Wellness Center (<https://students.dartmouth.edu/wellness-center/>)
5. The Student-Led Dartmouth Mental Health Union and their Peer Support Program in Collis may additionally be helpful to you
(<https://journeys.dartmouth.edu/mentalhealthunion/peer-support/>)
6. The Student-Led Sexual Assault Peer Alliance (SAPAs)
(<https://students.dartmouth.edu/health-service/counseling/presentations-trainings/sexual-assault-peer-alliance-sapas>)
7. UWILL – Teletherapy Services (free)
(<https://students.dartmouth.edu/health-service/counseling/appointments-services/comm-unity-therapist-options/uwill-teletherapy-services-students>)
8. UHELP – Crisis Line (free) – Call 833-646-1526
(<https://students.dartmouth.edu/health-service/counseling/about>)

9. Headspace – Mindfulness Meditation App:
(<https://students.dartmouth.edu/wellness-center/wellness-mindfulness/mindfulness-meditation/mindfulness-meditation-apps>)
10. The Tucker Center – Pastoral Counseling:
(<https://students.dartmouth.edu/tucker/about/pastoral-counseling>)

RELIGIOUS OBSERVANCES

You may wish to take part in religious observances that occur during this academic term. If you have a religious observance that conflicts with your participation in the course, please meet with one of us before the end of the second week of the term to discuss academic adjustments.

ACADEMIC SKILLS CENTER (ASC)

The Academic Skills Center is open to the entire Dartmouth Community and is located at Baker Library, Suite 224. To make an appointment call: (603) 646-2014 or visit their [Virtual Front Desk](#). For more information go to: <http://www.dartmouth.edu/~acskills/>

Here are some common reasons why you might visit the ASC:

- You want to get more comfortable talking in class.
- You are attending class regularly, but you feel like you are missing important points.
- You feel like you are a slow reader.
- You are having trouble completing assignments in the allotted time.
- You are spending hours studying for class, but you are still not “getting it.”
- You’ve never developed a time management system but want one now!

THE WRITING CENTER

The Writing Center is a place where you can meet with an undergraduate peer tutor to discuss a paper, research project, or multi-media assignment. The Center is located at 183 Berry. Writing Center tutors are trained to help you at any phase of your process. Whether you are brainstorming or planning, drafting, or structuring, tweaking, or polishing, peer tutors can provide feedback that will help you to create final products of which you can be proud. They can also help you interpret a prompt or guide you to get started when you feel stuck. [Click here to make an appointment](#).

SEXUAL RESPECT AND SEXUAL ASSAULT RESOURCES

At Dartmouth, we value integrity, responsibility, and respect for the rights and interests of others, all central to our Principles of Community. We are dedicated to establishing and maintaining a safe and inclusive campus where all have equal access to the educational and employment opportunities Dartmouth offers. We strive to promote an environment of sexual respect, safety, and well-being. In

its policies and standards, Dartmouth demonstrates unequivocally that sexual assault, gender-based harassment, domestic violence, dating violence, and stalking are not tolerated in our community. The Sexual Respect Website (<https://sexual-respect.dartmouth.edu>) at Dartmouth provides a wealth of information on your rights regarding sexual respect and resources that are available to all in our community.

Please note that, as a faculty member, we are required to share disclosures regarding conduct under Title IX with Dartmouth's Title IX Coordinator.

Confidential resources are also available and include licensed medical or counseling professionals (e.g., a licensed psychologist), staff members of organizations recognized as rape crisis centers under state law (such as WISE), and ordained clergy (see https://dartgo.org/titleix_resources). Should you have any questions, please feel free to contact Dartmouth's Title IX Coordinator or the Deputy Title IX Coordinator for the Guarini School. Their contact information can be found on the sexual respect website at: <https://sexual-respect.dartmouth.edu>.

In addition to campus resources, the [WISE](#) hotline provides 24-hour free, confidential, and privileged support and advocacy at (866) 348-9473. [WISE at Dartmouth](#) is a student organization focused on raising awareness, and Dartmouth's [Sexual Abuse Peer Advisors](#) are available to provide support and resources.

AN ADDITIONAL NOTE ABOUT ATTENDANCE

You are expected to attend class in person; however, there may be times when you need to miss class due to emergent circumstances like illness or other medical reasons, family emergencies, etc. Please do not attend class if you are sick, if you are in [isolation after testing positive for COVID-19](#), or if you have been instructed to stay home by Student Health Services. During the time you are not able to attend class in person, if you feel well enough, you can continue class work as detailed in Canvas. However, we encourage you to prioritize taking care of yourself if you are not feeling well or have diminished capacity. If you are unable to continue class work while absent or are out of class for longer than a week, we will work with you and your dean to chart the best path forward. While alternative arrangements may be made, this path may also include a recommended incomplete, course withdrawal, or medical withdrawal from the term.

WEEKLY THEMES & EXPERIENTIAL LEARNING

(For a detailed list of readings and assignments, see the Weekly Pages on Canvas.
Dates are subject to change depending on availability of our guests)

Week 1 – Cultural Context and Experiential Learning

Week 2 – Cultural Context and Learning to Look

Experiential Learning #1 : Come From Away (Northern Stage) – 9/24 – (Out-of-Class Experience, Dur. 3 h).

Meeting TBA

Experiential Learning #2 – *Learning to Look* at the Hood Museum of Art with Amelia Kahl '01. 09/25, 10:10 – Noon. Meet in the lobby of the museum at 10:05 a.m. (During Class).

Week 3 – Sense of Place and Shifting Perspectives

Experiential Learning #3 – *Towers and Tunnels: Shifting Perspectives*. Sept 30, 10:05 a.m. Meet at the center of The Green at 10:05. Wear comfortable shoes. (During Class).

Experiential Learning #4 – Jones Media Audio Editing Workshop #2 - Oct. 2

Week 4 – Narratives of Migrations and Mobility

Week 5 – Space, Place, Home

Week 6 – Cultural Humility and Critical Global Citizenship

Experiential Learning #5 Book Art workshop - Sarah Marcella Pirella

Experiential Learning #7 Poster Sessions at the HOOD - 10/21 ; 10/23

Week 7 – Tourism: Imaginaries and Itineraries

Experiential Learning #8: OCT 30,

TATAMI, film co-directed by Guy Nattiv and Zar Amir. Loew Auditorium, 7:00 pm. (TBC)

Week 8 – Project Week and Peer Review

Week 9 – Consolidating Intercultural Praxis

Week 10 – Warps and Wefts: Final Reflections

Final Breakfast and Art Show at the Jones Media Center

Assignment Due Dates (subject to change):**Week 1**

09/16 – Write-up: The Story of Your Name
09/18 - QQTP #1 (before class)
09/21 – Reflection Essay #1.

Week 2

09/23 – Jones Media Center Workshop #1(nothing due)
09/23 – Reading Annotation (de Oliveira and Nisbett) in Hypothesis
09/25 – QQTP #2 other readings (before class)
09/28 – Reflection Essay #2 (Learning to Look)

Week 3

9/30 – Tunnels and Tower
10/02 – Jones Media Center Workshop #2
10/05 – Reflection Essay #3 (Sense of Place, Shifting Perspectives)

Week 4

10/07 – Audio Assignment #1 – A Soundscape of Dartmouth/Hanover/Upper Valley
10/12 – Reflection Essay #4 – Migration and Mobility

Week 5

10/14 – Audio Assignment #2 – A Soundscape of Home
10/16 – QQTP #3
10/19 – Reflection Essay #5 – Cultures of Home

Week 6

10/21 – QQTP #4
10/26 – Poster Proposal Due

Week 7

10/28 – QQTP #5
10/30 – Paragraphs on Deconstructing Guidebook
11/2 – Audio Assignment #3 – Migration Stories Unscripted

Week 8

11/9 – Reflection Essay #6 –The Experience of Working collaboratively to create a public poster

Week 9

11/11 – Audio Assignment #4 – An Audio Postcard
09/16 – Reflection Essay #6 – Experience of Working Collaboratively (describe, interpret, evaluate, plan)
11/14 – Artist Statements due for Final Exhibit

Week 10

09/16 – Final Breakfast, Reflections, and Exhibit @ JMC